



Grameen Heroes - Grand Finale



NATIONAL PITCH EVENT

New Delhi, 4th July 2025

EVENT REPORT

Submitted by



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Grameen Heroes – Grand Finale

Empowering Rural Women Entrepreneurs Across India

July 4, 2025, Vishwa Yuvak Kendra, New Delhi

Executive Summary

In India's rural and semi-urban belts, women have long shouldered the invisible weight of labour, care, and survival. Yet, for decades, their aspirations for economic independence and leadership have remained largely unsupported by structured platforms that bridge capacity, access, and opportunity. *Project Grameen Heroes* was conceived as one of the modes for addressing this gap.

Project Grameen Heroes is a flagship CSR initiative of **Hero MotoCorp Ltd. (HMCL)**, implemented in partnership with **Association of Business Women in Commerce & Industry (ABWCI)**. The project was designed to surface, support, and scale women-led enterprises in rural and semi-urban India, particularly in districts surrounding HMCL's manufacturing units in **Uttarakhand, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Haryana, and Andhra Pradesh**.

Adapting the 'Shark Tank' model to rural realities, the initiative followed a structured process of outreach, selection, mentorship, and competitive pitching. Over **1,500 women** were engaged through on ground and digital mobilisation efforts. From **964 applications**, a rigorous multi-stage screening process led to **197 entrepreneurs** being selected for intensive capacity-building and five state-level pitch events held between April and June 2025.

The **pitch events in Uttarakhand, Rajasthan, Gujarat, and Haryana were conducted in person**, while the event for **Andhra Pradesh was held online**. The selected **women entrepreneurs presented their business plans** to regional juries comprising incubators, CSR leaders, entrepreneurs, business consultants, academics, local financiers, and senior leadership from HMCL. The pitches were evaluated on four key parameters: innovation, community impact, leadership, and scalability. Based on these criteria, **35 outstanding women entrepreneurs were selected to participate in the National Grand Finale**.

The lead-up to the finale involved deep, individualised support: customised pitch decks, financial articulation coaching, sectoral mentoring, and practice sessions, all delivered in accessible languages and formats. The Grand Finale was held on **July 4, 2025**, in New Delhi, where each finalist pitched before a national jury.

All 35 entrepreneurs were evaluated across ten parameters on a 0–5 scale. Based on cumulative jury averages, the **top 20 were awarded ₹1,00,000/-**, and the **remaining 15 received ₹25,000/-** each reflecting both merit and emerging promise. The finalists represented diverse sectors such as food processing, textiles, eco-products, digital services, and health, **with good representation from transgender women, persons with disabilities, and first-time nano entrepreneurs**.

What started as a small pilot to support grassroots businesses has now become a model for inclusive, community-driven growth, showing that with the right guidance, recognition, and funding, rural women can lead economic change, not just be part of it.

Context and Vision

Anchored in the belief that rural women are not just beneficiaries but builders of sustainable economies, the initiative brought together the vision of **HMCL** and the expertise of the **ABWCI in implementing community level development projects**. It was designed to surface, strengthen, and scale the entrepreneurial journeys of women who operate in rural parts of the country, often at the margins of visibility.

The project drew inspiration from the *Shark Tank* model and was adapted to fit the realities of India's rural enterprise ecosystem. Its core objectives have been threefold:

- **Visibility:** To offer rural women a national platform to present their business ideas and leadership potential
- **Viability:** To enhance enterprise feasibility through structured capacity building, mentorship, and funding
- **Voice:** To centre stories of resilience, innovation, and identity from across regions and backgrounds

This pilot project was strategically implemented across five states, **Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Haryana, Rajasthan, and Uttarakhand**, where HMCL has an established manufacturing presence. The outreach was concentrated in villages and districts surrounding HMCL's plants, specifically Chittoor, Halol, Dharuhera, Gurugram, Jaipur, Neemrana, and Haridwar. The geographic focus was designed to catalyse local impact by linking corporate presence with community potential.

Grand Finale Participation Highlights

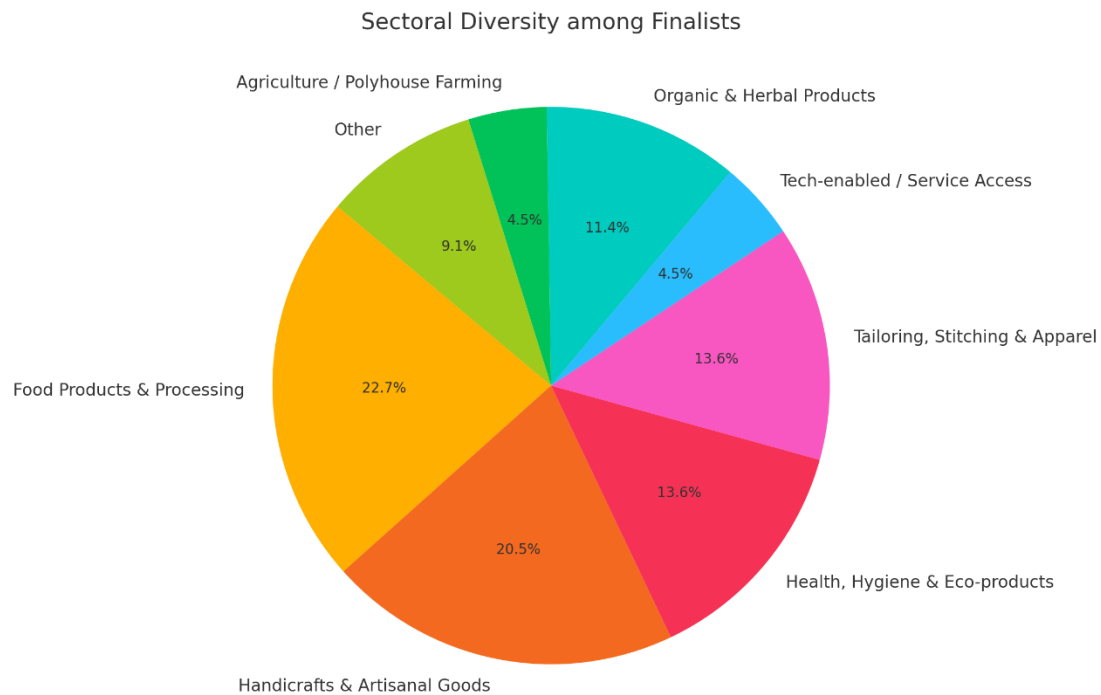
The Grand Finale of **Project Grameen Heroes** brought together a vibrant and powerful collective of **35 rural women entrepreneurs**. Each finalist earned her place through a rigorous selection process that spanned months of state-level outreach, capacity building, and pitching rounds. The following table enlists the demographic and business diversity of the finalists-

State	No. of Finalists	Sample Sectors Represented
Uttarakhand	12	Natural fibres, herbal soaps, trans-inclusive food services
Rajasthan	7	Crochet décor, natural cleaners, customised curtain-making
Gujarat	6	Ayurvedic powders, artificial jewellery, candle-making

Haryana	7	Poultry, tailoring, cosmetic retail, Common Service Centre
Andhra Pradesh	3	Handloom weaving, organic farming, kalamkari tailoring
Total	35	

In Andhra Pradesh, three entrepreneurs were selected for the National Finale from a cohort of fifteen at the State-Level Pitch. To arrive at the final number of national finalists, two additional entrepreneurs were drawn from Uttarakhand, bringing the total number from the state to twelve. This decision reflected both the strength of the pitches emerging from Uttarakhand and the programme's flexible approach to recognizing excellence across the board, while ensuring fair representation in the National Pitch. The following table highlights the sectoral business diversity of the finalists -

Sector	Percentage (%)	Number of Finalists
Food Products & Processing	22.7%	8
Handicrafts & Artisanal Goods	20.5%	7
Health, Hygiene & Eco-products	13.6%	5
Tailoring, Stitching & Apparel	13.6%	5
Organic & Herbal Products	11.4%	4
Other	9.1%	3
Agriculture / Polyhouse Farming	4.5%	2
Tech-enabled / Service Access	4.5%	1



From an early outreach to the grand finale pitch stage, the initiative **upheld a strong commitment to inclusion**-not as tokenism, but as practice. The programme actively reached and supported **transgender women, persons with disabilities, and both traditional and non-traditional entrepreneurs** from underrepresented backgrounds. On the day of the finale, **3 transgender women and 4 entrepreneurs with disabilities** presented their businesses before the national jury.

Shortlisting & Capacity Building for the Grand Finale

Recognizing that national-level pitching required a higher level of preparedness, ABWCI designed an intensive, personalized capacity-building plan for every selected entrepreneur.

Finalists were connected with **ABWCI's core team as well as their respective state coordinators** immediately after the state events. This marked the beginning of a dedicated scaffolding phase, structured to ensure all women were supported in the lead-up to the grand finale. **Pitch practice sessions** were conducted systematically - first in state-wise groups, allowing participants to build on peer learning and regional camaraderie, and then individual pitch sessions that addressed specific enterprise-level gaps and pitch articulation needs. These sessions were not one-off interactions, but part of a sustained rhythm of support.

A **hybrid model of engagement** was followed. State coordinators provided **in-person guidance**, helping finalists refine their business documentation, product portfolios, and delivery styles. Simultaneously, the ABWCI team held **multiple rounds of Zoom sessions**, offering sector-specific feedback, financial articulation coaching, and confidence-building support.

In addition, **dedicated pitch decks** were created for each finalist, tailored to their enterprise story and product offerings. It followed a simple, narrative-driven format structured across

7-8 slides, which included an overview of the entrepreneur's business, details of products/services, current operations, financials (investment, revenue, profit), and a business development plan with specific funding needs. Each deck concluded with the intended impact and future vision, using accessible language and visuals to strengthen clarity and relatability.

This phase was not just about preparing for a pitch, it was about ensuring that each finalist, regardless of background or prior exposure, walked into the Grand Finale with clarity, confidence, and command.

Finale Overview

Inaugural Ceremony

The Grand Finale of Project Grameen Heroes opened with a powerful inaugural session that brought together voices from across the ecosystem - corporate leadership, programme anchors, and grassroots enablers.

Delivering the Welcome address, **Mr. Parul Soni, Founder & Secretary General, ABWCI**, spoke with conviction about the shared journey that brought the 35 finalists to this national stage. He reflected on the scale and spirit of Project Grameen Heroes, noting that over 1,500 women engaged with the programme at its inception. Emphasizing the importance of collective learning, he encouraged everyone in the room to network, learn from each other's successes and failures. He appealed to the jury to approach their role with empathy and foresight, looking not only at current potential but at long-term promise. In closing, he congratulated the finalists, thanked all partners and team members for their commitment, and expressed hope for continued collaboration and stronger momentum for rural women-led enterprises in the years ahead.



Figure 1: Sonika Chopra, Lead, CSR, HMCL addressing the gathering at the Inaugural Ceremony

Taking the stage at the Grand Finale, **Ms. Sonika Chopra, Lead, CSR, Hero MotoCorp Ltd.**, underlined the Company's sustained support for grassroots-led projects. Her message was clear and affirming, every participant in this journey is a hero, regardless of gender, background, or scale of enterprise. She spoke with pride about HMCL's commitment to diversity and inclusion, and their belief in empowering communities through action. Reflecting on the journey that began in December-January, Ms. Chopra acknowledged the dedication shown by both the participants and organisers. Expressing confidence in women's leadership and resilience, she affirmed HMCL's commitment to walking alongside these entrepreneurs beyond the pitch and into real-world growth.

In the closing remarks, **Ms. Savita Sethi, Director, Programmes, ABWCI**, laid out the **genesis and evolution** of Project Grameen Heroes, tracing its arc from a bold idea to a five-state implementation journey that reached deep into rural India. Ms. Sethi shared key milestones from the implementation journey:

- **1,500+ women** engaged through outreach and mobilisation across the five states
- **964 applicants** submitted the applications
- **861 applications** were screened
- **200+ women entrepreneurs** received mentorship and capacity-building support
- **5 state-level pitch rounds** conducted in **Uttarakhand, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Haryana, and Andhra Pradesh**
- **35 exceptional finalists** selected to compete at the **Grand Finale**

From orientation calls and field visits to pitch deck creation and one-on-one coaching, she outlined the layers of support provided by local coordinators and ABWCI team. The process, she noted, was not just inclusive, but transformative. She concluded by officially introducing the jury panel and thanking the HMCL team for their presence at the Grand Finale, as well as for their unwavering support throughout the programme.



Figure 2: The Jury and the finalists during the Introduction Round

Alongside the formal proceedings, the Grand Finale also featured a **product exhibition** showcasing the innovations and business offerings from some of the finalists. Each entrepreneur brought samples and materials that visually supported their pitch presentations and reflected the diversity, craftsmanship, and purpose-driven innovation that defined this cohort.



Figure 3: Exhibition of Products by the finalists

Event Format

The format of the event was structured to create space for both critical evaluation and celebration. Each entrepreneur, having undergone a rigorous capacity-building programme and multiple rounds of mentoring, was invited to pitch her business idea to a national-level jury.

To ensure adequate time and attention for each pitch, the event followed a **parallel jury room format**, similar to the structure used during the state-level rounds. This allowed for simultaneous presentations across two jury panels, ensuring a focused and respectful evaluation environment.



Figure 4: Parallel Jury sessions ongoing

Each pitch was allotted **10 minutes** — **7 minutes for presentation** and **3 minutes for jury Q&A**. The finalists presented a wide range of businesses, from organic farming and herbal wellness products to digital services, handcrafted art, and eco-sustainable manufacturing. All

itches were made in **Hindi**, supported by **detailed pitch presentations** designed for each finalist as part of their preparation for the grand finale round.

Jury Composition

The **National Jury** was composed of **eight distinguished members** drawn from the fields of social entrepreneurship, CSR, women's leadership, and grassroots innovation. Their task was not only to assess each pitch but to recognize the depth of effort, context, and intent behind each idea. The evaluation criteria focused on four interlinked parameters: the **viability of the business model**, **clarity of vision**, **potential for community impact**, and the **entrepreneur's leadership capacity**.

JURY 1



Angad Singh
Co-Founder & Director
of EasyRewardz



Aarti Bindra
MD ACPL Systems,
Klassify Technology,
AttackFence



Sonali Mathur
AGM, Corporate
Affairs, HMCL



Dr Sujita Khemka
POSH Chairperson,
HMCL

JURY 2



Bhumika Deswal
President, Haryana,
ABWCI



Amit Shukla
Co-founder & Director,
Simpler Today



Dipanwita Chakraborty
Sustainability &
Impact Leader



Labony Sanyal
Head, Corporate Adm &
Facility Mgmt, HMCL

Entrepreneurial highlights

The finalists at the *Grameen Heroes Grand Finale* represented a remarkable cross-section of India's rural enterprise ecosystem. Each finalist's journey reflected a confluence of sectoral insight, cultural rootedness, and social commitment.



Figure 5: A finalist presenting her product samples to the Jury

From Uttarakhand, **Zainab Siddiqui's** venture *Eco-Carve* converts pine needles and agricultural residue into eco-friendly wood substitutes, tackling forest fire risks while building a sustainable product line. **Aditi Sharma**, the first transgender woman entrepreneur from the state, pitched her food initiative *Nivala Pyaar Ka*, centred on dignity, home-cooked meals, and trans inclusion in the workforce.

In Rajasthan, **Karnika Bai's** paper mâché décor studio *Astitva Art* stood out not just for its craftsmanship but for its vision to use design as a medium of self-determination for transgender individuals. **Ravina Singh**, also from the trans community, leads *Bhuvaji Achar Papad Udyog*, employing differently abled and trans persons to sell food items. Their models reflected enterprise as an act of empowerment. Not charity, but ownership.

Several finalists had grown their businesses from self-help group efforts into semi-formal ventures. **Deepmala Suthar's** 13-year journey with handcrafted crochet in Udaipur has now evolved into a crochet toy brand with ambitions of e-commerce integration. **Mudita Singh** from Haryana established a steel scrubber manufacturing unit with her husband after joblessness pushed them to take a risk. Today, she's expanding into green cleaning products and branding under *Mahalaxmi Enterprises*.



Figure 6: Finalists interacting with the Jury during their pitch sessions

The cohort also included first-time entrepreneurs like **Twinkal** from Jaipur, who entered the male-dominated e-commerce delivery space. Renting a scooter, she built a daily delivery network while resisting family pressure and community backlash. Her goal is to own a vehicle, reduce costs, and inspire other women to enter the logistics sector.

In Gujarat, **Nazimabanu Makarani's** handcrafted scented candles are already being supplied as wedding and corporate gifts. **Vaishaliben Solanki's** home-based pickle business now supplies hotels and aims to enter institutional canteens. Others like **Kalpanaben Rathod** run food supply chains across Anganwadis, or like **Zankhanaben Purohit**, are processing ayurvedic powders and teas through women-led collectives.



Figure 7: A finalist presenting her pitch, supported by the Pitch deck in the background

Their enterprises spanned critical sectors - food processing, eco-products, textiles, digital services, rural logistics, and health and hygiene - but the common thread was community. Nearly all finalists expressed the intent to expand not only their income, but also local employment. Some already employ 5–10 women; others aim to set up training centres or collectives to formalise women's labour and enable scale.

Importantly, the cohort reflected the programme's **commitment to inclusion** in every form - not as a principle on paper, but as practice. Among the 35 were transgender women, women from minority communities, those with disabilities, and women with no formal education or urban exposure. For several, this was their first time travelling alone from their native place or presenting in a professional forum.

Beyond its evaluative purpose, the Grand Finale was also a space for **connection, visibility, and solidarity**. Many women had travelled long distances, some accompanied by young children or family members, reflecting the seriousness with which they approached this opportunity. For several participants, this was their first time pitching in a formal setting outside their home state—a powerful moment of growth, recognition, and shared aspiration.

Awards Ceremony

The **Awards Ceremony** at the Grand Finale of *Project Grameen Heroes* embodied the programme's inclusive spirit and its core belief: that every woman who made it to the national

stage is a **changemaker**. These were not just entrepreneurs – they were innovators, problem-solvers, and local leaders who had redefined what’s possible in their respective contexts.

Each of the 35 finalists was evaluated across ten key parameters, including problem identification, innovation, entrepreneurial spirit, market potential, financial understanding, revenue model, return on investment, founder capability, impact potential, and overall pitch delivery. Jury members assigned scores from 1 to 5 on each parameter, based on a defined rubric. The average score was calculated from the cumulative marks given by all jury members on the panel.

Following this rigorous assessment process, **all 35 finalists** were awarded **seed funding**, acknowledging both potential and perseverance.

- The **top 20**, based on their average scores, received **₹1,00,000 each** – typically reflecting strong scalability, revenue models, or clear capital needs for machinery, inventory, or infrastructure.
- The **remaining 15**, each awarded **₹25,000**, demonstrated early-stage promise, deep community relevance, and strong intent to grow. This tiered structure ensured both merit-based recognition and inclusive support for diverse entrepreneurial journeys.

The awards were formally presented by Ms. Sonika Chopra, Lead, CSR, HMCL and Mr. Parul Soni, Founder & Secretary General, ABWCI alongside members of the HMCL leadership and the Jury.



Figure 8: The Award being presented to a Winner

Special Recognitions

In addition to celebrating the 35 women finalists, the Grand Finale also honoured the many individuals who played pivotal roles in enabling and sustaining the programme.

As **Vision Partners**, members of the HMCL leadership & CSR team were recognised for their strategic direction, unwavering commitment, and deep involvement throughout the programme. These included **Ms. Sonika Chopra**, **Mr. Kunal Gupta**, and **Ms. Subha Kawatra**, each of whom played a critical role in shaping the programme's structure and values.



Figure 9: Mr Parul Soni felicitating Ms Sonika Chopra with the 'Vision Partner' recognition

Certificates of Appreciation were presented to the members of the **National Jury**, in recognition of the time, insight, and thoughtful evaluation they brought to the Grand Finale.

Finally, the dedicated group of **Impact Enablers and Volunteers**, were also acknowledged for their on-ground leadership, mentorship, and logistical coordination which ensured smooth implementation which was empathetic and participant-centred. This group included **Dr. Juhi Garg**, **Tanishka Gupta**, **Nikunj Patel**, **Hardik Patel**, **Hetalben Patel**, **Y. Umare Farook**, **Badri Sharma**, **Nikhil Verma**, **Sakshi Chaudhary**, and **R. S. Deshwal**.

The Grand Finale drew to a close with heartfelt reflections from key leaders who had been instrumental in shaping the journey of *Project Grameen Heroes*. **Mr. Parul Soni** spoke of the transformation he had witnessed – not just in the entrepreneurs, but in the ecosystem around them. He urged all stakeholders to carry this momentum forward, emphasizing that real change takes root when initiatives like these are sustained over time, across contexts, and in policy and practice.

Ms. Sonika Chopra reiterated Hero MotoCorp's belief in community-led change, and reflected on the courage and clarity of the women who had pitched their businesses. She reminded the audience that *"seed capital is only the beginning – what matters is how we continue"*

to walk together.” Her closing note echoed the day’s sentiment: that these 35 women represent not just enterprise, but hope, strength, and leadership.

Mr. Kunal Gupta, from the HMCL CSR team, delivered the formal closing remarks. Applauding the finalists for their determination, he thanked the jury, volunteers, and partners for their tireless commitment. He described the event as not just a culmination, but a launchpad for deeper partnerships and long-term impact, grounded in the belief that rural women’s entrepreneurship can redefine local economies.



Figure 10: Kunal Gupta, HMCL, congratulating all the Winners during the Valedictory Ceremony

The reflections concluded with a group photograph, capturing the spirit of the day - a vibrant assembly of winners, jury members, organisers, mentors, and partners standing side by side, united by purpose and possibility.

Reflections and Impact

The *Grameen Heroes Grand Finale* was more than a pitch event. It was a collective assertion that rural women are not waiting to be empowered; they are already leading, innovating, and creating value. What they need is visibility, validation, and investment. And when that is provided with care, structure, and respect, the outcomes extend far beyond enterprise.

Across all five participating states, the initiative has surfaced deep-rooted entrepreneurial energy that had remained unsupported for lack of access to networks, capital, and formal mentorship. Each pitch revealed not just a business model, but a vision. Many of the entrepreneurs had entered the programme with no prior exposure to structured funding

opportunities. Several had never travelled outside their village. Yet on the day of the finale, they spoke - sometimes in Hindi, supported with local language in parts, sometimes with nervous pauses - about logistics, scale, sourcing, pricing strategy, and business growth. This shift from self-doubt to self-assurance was one of the programme's most powerful outcomes.

The journey also demonstrated that when financial support is combined with contextual mentorship delivered in local languages and through hybrid formats, it becomes transformational. Women who began the programme hesitant to introduce themselves were, by the finale, defending their margins, negotiating investment, and visualising five-year expansion plans.

At a systemic level, *Project Grameen Heroes* redefined what rural women's enterprise looks like - moving it beyond tailoring and handicrafts to include mushroom farming, ayurvedic processing, delivery logistics, natural cleaning products, and wood substitutes from agricultural waste. Equally important was the creation of a pan-Indian sisterhood. Many finalists have decided to collaborate as business partners, to learn from each other's stories and to remain in touch through WhatsApp groups, supporting one another with orders, advice, and moral encouragement. As one finalist remarked during the closing ceremony, *"I came thinking I was alone. I leave knowing I am part of something bigger."*



Figure 11: All the Awardees during the Valedictory Ceremony

What *Grameen Heroes* has made visible is a quiet but formidable shift. It is the transformation of women's labour into leadership. Of small businesses into anchors of local development. This is not the end of the journey. It is the moment where recognition catches up with reality.

Testimonials

"मैं हीरो मोटोकॉर्प और ABWCI का दिल से धन्यवाद करती हूँ, जिन्होंने मुझे इतना सपोर्ट किया। स्पेशली, एक ट्रांसवुमन होने के नाते — मेरे लिए यह सपना जैसा है कि मैं ऐसे प्लेटफॉर्म पर जाकर खुद को रिप्रेजेंट कर सकूँ, जहाँ मुझे मेरे काम के लिए सम्मान और आर्थिक सहयोग मिल रहा है, जिससे मैं अपने बिज़नेस को आगे बढ़ा सकूँ। बाकी तो समाज ने हमेशा ही तिरस्कार और अलग नजर से देखा, लेकिन आज हीरो मोटोकॉर्प और ABWCI की तरफ से जो सपोर्ट मिला है, वह मेरे लिए बहुत मायने रखता है। थैंक यू सो मच!"

कर्णिका, राजस्थान



"यह मेरी ज़िंदगी का एक ऐसा पल है, जो मेरी ज़िंदगी में पहले कभी नहीं आया। सॉरी, यह सिर्फ मेरी नहीं, मेरे समाज की भी बात है। मैं आज पहली बार दिल्ली आई हूँ और इस प्रोग्राम के ज़रिए मुझे धनराशि प्राप्त हुई है। मैं इससे अपना बिज़नेस और भी आगे बढ़ाऊंगी, और आने वाली पीढ़ी को प्रेरित करूंगी कि हमें पुराने ताने-बाने से हटकर कुछ नया करना है। धन्यवाद!"

अदिति शर्मा, उत्तराखंड

"मेरा नाम कल्पना है। मैंने कभी दिल्ली देखा भी नहीं था। मैंने सपने में भी नहीं सोचा था, लेकिन सपने में देखा था कि दिल्ली ऐसा होगा। थैंक्यू हीरो मोटोकॉर्प और उन सभी को जिन्होंने मेरे प्रोडक्ट और मेरे बारे में सुना और हमें समझा। थैंक्यू, जो हमें धनराशि की आवश्यकता थी— उसे हम अपने धंधे में यूज़ करके और आगे बढ़ेंगे। थैंक यू!"

कल्पना, गुजरात



"यह मेरे लिए सिर्फ एक कंपटीशन नहीं है — मेरे लिए यह बहुत बड़ा अवसर है। मैं पहली बार इस तरह से बाहर निकली हूँ, और अब जो लेडीज़ मेरे साथ जुड़ना चाहती हैं, उन्हें भी मैं सपोर्ट करूंगी। मैं ग्रामीण हीरोज़ का दिल से थैंक यू करती हूँ, जिन्होंने मुझे यहां इनवाइट किया।"

दीपमाला सुथार, राजस्थान

"नमस्ते। आज मैं बहुत खुश हूँ क्योंकि मैं पहली बार अपने घर से और अपने गुजरात से बाहर निकली हूँ। मैंने कभी दिल्ली नहीं देखा था। लेकिन हीरो मोटोकॉर्प और ABWCI की वजह से हम दिल्ली तक पहुँच पाए। आज हमने प्रोग्राम अटेंड किया और सुबह हम बहुत नर्वस थे कि आज क्या होगा, कैसे होगा, अपनी स्पीच कैसे देंगे। लेकिन हमारा प्रपोज़ल बहुत बढ़िया रहा और हमें जो धनराशि की आवश्यकता थी, वह भी मिल गई। आज हम बहुत खुश हैं। थैंक यू!"

सोलंकी वैशालीबेन, गुजरात



आज मुझे बहुत अच्छा लगा कि काफी सारी लेडीज़ आई हैं, अपने-अपने बिज़नेस और आइडिया लेकर आई हैं। मुझे देखकर ऐसा लग रहा है कि अब समाज में कुछ करने की इच्छा और समाज से जुड़ाव और भी गहरा हो गया है। यहां की पूरी टीम और सभी मेंबर्स को मैं थैंक्यू बोलूंगी। हीरो मोटोकॉर्प को भी थैंक्यू, जिन्होंने मुझे सहयोग राशि प्रदान की। हम आशा करते हैं कि भविष्य में भी ऐसा सहयोग मिलता रहेगा।"

रवीना सिंह, राजस्थान

"मेरा नाम सुनीता जी है। यहां पहुंचकर मुझे बहुत अच्छा लग रहा है। जो मुझे धनराशि मिली है, उससे मैं अपना काम बढ़ाना चाहती हूँ। यहां आकर मुझे बहुत खुशी हुई है। मैं अपने परिवार से भी ज़्यादा खुश हूँ। मुझे ऐसा लग रहा है जैसे यहां मुझे मेरे मम्मी-पापा मिल गए — आज जैसे मुझे एक पूरी फैमिली मिल गई हो। किसी ने साथ नहीं दिया, लेकिन आज Hero Company और ABWCI के साथ जुड़कर मुझे बहुत खुशी हो रही है।"

सुनीता, हरियाणा



"थैंक यू, थैंक यू सो मच! ग्रामीण हीरो के साथ जो मेरा आज का एक्सपीरियंस रहा, वह इतना-इतना-इतना वंडरफुल रहा कि मेरे पास शब्द ही नहीं हैं। अब जो धनराशि मुझे मिली है, मैं उसे अपने काम में लगाऊंगी। मैं इससे दो मशीनें लूंगी और साथ में फूल खरीदूंगी। मैं सोच रही हूँ कि इस काम को 1 से 4 गुना करूँ। जो धनराशि मुझे मिली है, मैं उसका चौगुना करके अपने काम को और अधिक से अधिक बड़ा बनाऊंगी। थैंक यू, थैंक यू सो मच!"

भावना मेहरा, उत्तराखंड

Annexures

Annexure A: Finalists' Profiles at a Glance

S. No.	Name	State	District	Sector / Enterprise Type
1	Beena Pundir	Uttarakhand	Tehri Garhwal	Handicrafts from natural fibres
2	Pushpa Kumari	Uttarakhand	Dehradun	Chemical-free food products
3	Zainab Siddiqui	Uttarakhand	Tehri Garhwal	Sustainable NRF boards
4	Aditi Sharma	Uttarakhand	Dehradun	Home-cooked food (trans inclusion)
5	Babli Koranga	Uttarakhand	Udham Singh Nagar	Cow dung-based eco-products
6	Rakhi Gupta	Uttarakhand	Nainital	Aipan folk art
7	Jesal Kumar	Uttarakhand	Dehradun	South Indian food & batter
8	Sangeeta Verma	Uttarakhand	Dehradun	Temple waste incense sticks
9	Sunita Devi	Uttarakhand	Dehradun	Herbal soaps
10	Farjana Khan	Uttarakhand	Dehradun	Mushroom cultivation
11	Bhavna Mehra	Uttarakhand	Nainital	Woollen soft toys
12	Meena Devi	Uttarakhand	Almora	Polyhouse farming
13	Deepmala Suthar	Rajasthan	Udaipur	Crochet art & home décor
14	Mamta Gormat	Rajasthan	Rajsamand	Natural cleaning & beauty products
15	Twinkle	Rajasthan	Jaipur	E-commerce delivery
16	Karnika Bai	Rajasthan	Jaipur	Paper mâché eco-decor (trans inclusion)
17	Raveena Singh	Rajasthan	Jaipur	Papad and pickle enterprise
18	Anjali Sharma	Rajasthan	Rajsamand	Chilli spice manufacturing
19	Seema Gautam	Rajasthan	Jaipur	Customised curtain-making

20	Makriani Nazimabanu	Gujarat	Vadodara	Scented candle production
21	Dharmishtaben Chauhan	Gujarat	Vadodara	Handmade artificial jewellery
22	Vaishaliben Solanki	Gujarat	Vadodara	Pickle-making and tailoring
23	Snehlataben Rathod	Gujarat	Panchmahal	Perfumed diya manufacturing
24	Zankhanaben Purohit	Gujarat	Vadodara	Ayurvedic herbs and powders
25	Kalpanaben Rathod	Gujarat	Panchmahal	Canteen & tiffin service
26	Hemlata	Haryana	Nuh	Poultry farming
27	Savitri Devi	Haryana	Palwal	Mats, garments, and cosmetic retail
28	Sunita	Haryana	Faridabad	Cosmetics & tailoring
29	Anita	Haryana	Nuh	Tailoring & jute bags
30	Mudita Singh	Haryana	Faridabad	Steel scrubbers & cleaning goods
31	Satyawati	Haryana	Palwal	Common Service Centre
32	Sunita D/O Satvir	Haryana	Palwal	Diya production
33	G. Kalyani	Andhra Pradesh	Tirupati	Organic fruits and vegetables
34	S. D. Shaheen	Andhra Pradesh	Tirupati	Reed handloom weaving
35	M. Tameena	Andhra Pradesh	Tirupati	Embroidered tailoring & kalamkari

Annexure B: List of Winners

WINNERS OF INR 1,00,000		
S. NO.	NAME	STATE
1	Mamta	Rajasthan
2	Pushpa Kumari	Uttarkhand
3	Zainab Siddiqui	Uttarkhand
4	Aditi Sharma	Uttarkhand
5	Babli Koranga	Uttarkhand
6	Rakhi Gupta	Uttarkhand
7	Jesal Kumar	Uttarkhand
8	Sangeeta	Uttarkhand
9	Sunita Devi	Uttarkhand
10	Bhawana Mehra	Uttarkhand
11	Meena Devi	Uttarkhand
12	Karnika Bai (Pradeep)	Rajasthan
13	Ravina (Ravindra Singh)	Rajasthan
14	Solanki Vaishali Ben	Gujarat
15	Snehlalben Nikulsinh Rathod	Gujarat
16	Zankhanaben Pundrik Kumar Purohit	Gujarat
17	Sunita Palwal	Haryana
18	Sunita	Haryana
19	Hemlata W/O Ram Lal	Haryana
20	Kalpnaben Manojsinh Rathod	Gujarat

WINNERS OF INR 25,000		
S. NO.	NAME	STATE
1	Deepmala Suthar	Rajasthan
2	Beena Pundir	Uttarakhand
3	Twinkle	Rajasthan
4	Farjana	Uttarakhand
5	Seema Gautam	Rajasthan
6	Anjali Sharma	Rajasthan
7	Makriani Najimabanu	Gujarat
8	Chauhan Dharmishtaben Hitendrasinh	Gujarat
9	Savitri Devi	Haryana
10	Anita W/O Sandeep Kumar	Haryana
11	Mudita Singh	Haryana
12	Satyawati	Haryana
13	G Kalyani	Andhra Pradesh
14	S D Shaheen	Andhra Pradesh
15	M Tameena	Andhra Pradesh

Annexure C: Event Agenda

Timings	Details
10:00 - 10:15 AM	Registrations & High Tea
10:15 - 11:00 AM	<i>Inaugural Ceremony</i> Introduction and Context Setting by Parul Soni, Founder & Secretary General, ABWCI Opening remarks by Sonika Chopra, Lead, CSR, HMCL Round of Introductions by Jury Members and Participants
11:00 - 2:00 PM	2 Parallel Juries consisting of 4 Judges examining a total of 35 finalists <i>Each participant will get 10 minutes – Business pitch will run for 7 minutes, followed by a QnA Session for 3 minutes</i>
2:00 – 3:00 PM	Lunch Consolidation of the Results & Preparation for the Awards Ceremony
3:00 - 4:00 PM	<i>Awards Ceremony</i>
4:00 - 4:30 PM	Recording of Testimonials and Group Photo of the finalists with the Jury, HMCL & ABWCI teams

Annexure D: Glimpses from the Event







ग्रामीण हीरोज़

उत्तराखंड



पुष्पा कुमारी (प्रभा श्री)

देहरादून, उत्तराखंड

- **व्यवसाय का नाम:** रसपर्णा ग्रीन
- **उत्पाद/सेवा:** उत्तराखंड के हिमालयी कृषि उत्पादों की रीपैकेजिंग तथा प्रीमियम क्वालिटी के केमिकल-मुक्त स्वास्थ्यवर्धक होममेड खाद्य उत्पादों का निर्माण
- **व्यवसाय का स्वरूप:** एकल प्रोप्राइटरशिप
- **आयु:** 37 वर्ष
- **वैवाहिक स्थिति:** विवाहित





मेरे व्यवसाय के बारे में

- **उद्भव** - रसपर्णा ग्रीन के साथ मेरी यात्रा 2022 में आरंभ हुई। पूरी दुनिया के साथ कोविड महामारी की पीड़ा को झेलते हुए मैंने समझ लिया था कि हमारी रोगप्रतिरोधक क्षमता यानी इम्युनिटी ही रोगों से अंततः हमारी रक्षा करती है और अच्छी इम्युनिटी के लिए शुद्ध प्राकृतिक आहार महत्वपूर्ण है। बाजार में खान-पान के शुद्ध और हेल्दी विकल्प कम हैं जबकि केमिकलयुक्त मिलावटी चीजों की भरमार है।
- **चुनौतियाँ** : स्थान और पूंजी के रूप में समुचित संसाधन जुटाना और अच्छी गुणवत्ता के कच्चे माल प्राप्त करना।
- **इस व्यवसाय का महत्व**: 1. उच्च गुणवत्ता वाले शुद्ध प्राकृतिक खाद्य उत्पादों को बढ़ावा देने से लोगों में इम्युनिटी और स्वास्थ्य के प्रति जगरुकता बढ़ेगी 2. जैविक कृषि उत्पादों का सही मूल्य देकर उत्तराखंड में पलायन की ओर अग्रसर पहाड़ी भूमि धारकों को जैविक कृषि की ओर पुनः आकर्षित करने में मदद मिलेगी 3. उत्तराखंड के लोगों खास कर महिलाओं के लिए राज्य के अंदर ही सम्मानजनक रोजगार के अवसर पैदा होंगे।

मेरे व्यवसाय के बारे में

2022 में टीचिंग की जिम्मेदारी से मुक्त होकर मैंने उत्तराखंड के ऊँचे हिमालयन क्षेत्रों में उगाई जाने वाली दुर्लभ ऑर्गेनिक हल्दी और मेरे खुद के बनाए 4 प्रकार के होममेड हेल्दी प्रोबायोटिक पिकल्स से अपने काम की आधारशिला रखी।

- मेरी इस यात्रा को अब तीन 3 वर्ष पूरे होने को हैं और आज रसपर्णा ग्रीन के पास रीपिकेज्ड और सेल्फ-प्रॉसेस्ड प्रॉडक्ट के रूप में 50 से अधिक उत्पाद हैं।
- हमारे उत्पादों के बाजार ऑनलाइन और ऑफलाइन दोनों हैं। अपनी वेबसाइट www.rasparnagreen.com के अलावा हम अमेज़न इंडिया के जरिए भी अपने उत्पाद बेचते हैं जहाँ हमें देश भर से ऑर्डर प्राप्त होते हैं। अपने खुद के रसपर्णा ग्रीन आउटलेट के अलावा देहरादून शहर के स्थानीय चुनिंदा रीटेल शॉप हमारा ऑफलाइन बाजार हैं।
- नेचुरल प्रॉडक्ट लाइन में हमारे पास हेल्दी मिल्क प्रीमिक्स, आयुर्वेदिक टी सीजनिंग, हाई कालिटी के इन्ग्रीडिएंट्स से तैयार किए गए मिक्स मसालों की प्रीमियम रेंज, पहाड़ी मसालों और जड़ी-बूटियों से तैयार हर्बल सीजनिंग सॉल्ट, पारंपरिक तरीके से बने सनड़ाइड पिकल्स, पहाड़ी आंवलों से बने कैंडी और डाइजेस्टिव फ्रेशनर, पहाड़ी माल्टे का स्कैश जैसे हेल्दी उत्पाद शामिल हैं।



मेरे व्यवसाय के बारे में

व्यवसाय की शुरुआत हमने अपने पास की छोटी सी जमा-पूंजी से की थी। मूल्य निर्धारण में हमने उत्पाद की ऊंची गुणवत्ता की लागत के बावजूद इस बात का ध्यान रखा है कि यह 'वैल्यू फॉर मनी' हो और ग्राहक के ऊपर इसका अनावश्यक बोझ न पड़े।

- प्रारंभिक निवेश: 40,000/-
- उत्पाद मूल्य निर्धारण – हमारे उत्पाद INR 30 से लेकर INR 1400/- के रेंज में उपलब्ध हैं।
- मेरी मासिक आय: 2,00,000/- (औसत)
- मेरा मासिक लाभ: 25,000/- (औसत)



व्यवसाय विकास योजना

- हमारा अगला कदम है हमारे निवास स्थान से निकालकर व्यवसाय को एक अलग उत्पादन स्थल (प्रॉडक्शन साइट) प्रदान करना और लक्ष्य है उत्पादन बढ़ाकर अपने उत्पादों की बढ़ती हुई मांग को पूरा करना और बाजार का विस्तार करना।
- हमारी योजना इस प्रकार है:
- उत्पादन के लिए अलग स्पेस लेना
- उत्पादन और पैकेजिंग की मशीनों पर निवेश करना, कच्चे माल और पैकेजिंग सामग्री की खरीद पर निवेश बढ़ाना
- मार्केटिंग और विज्ञापन पर निवेश करना
- अतिरिक्त संख्या में कर्मचारी नियुक्त करना

व्यवसाय विकास योजना

20 लाख रु. की वित्तीय सहायता मेरा अनुरोध है।

- मुझे अपने व्यवसाय के विस्तार के लिए पूंजी की आवश्यकता है।
- इस पूंजी का उपयोग उत्पादन और पैकेजिंग के लिए अलग स्थान लेने, यंत्र और मशीनरी, कच्चे माल तथा पैकेजिंग सामग्री खरीदने और कर्मचारियों की संख्या बढ़ाने पर किया जाना है।
- आवश्यक पूंजी का विवरण :
 - यंत्र और मशीनरी : 6,000,00/-
 - पैकेजिंग सामग्री: 3,000,00/-
 - कच्चा माल/कृषि उत्पाद: 9,000,00/-
 - मार्केटिंग और विज्ञापन : 1,000,00/-
 - कर्मचारी: 1,000,00/-

प्रभाव

- मेरे लिए यह अवसर अपने व्यवसाय की उपयोगिता, उसकी चुनौतियां साझा करने और व्यवसाय विस्तार के लिए आवश्यक सहायता और समर्थन तलाशने के लिए महत्वपूर्ण है।
- इस सहयोग और समर्थन से हम अपना उत्पान और विपणन बढ़ाकर राजस्व अर्जन में वृद्धि कर पाएंगे।
- निःसंदेह, व्यवसाय का विस्तार होने से न केवल हम कच्चे माल की प्राप्ति के लिए अधिक से अधिक किसानों से जुड़ेंगे बल्कि बढ़ते हुए उत्पादन और विपणन की जरूरतों को पूरा करने के लिए अधिक संख्या में महिला कामगारों को भी नियुक्त करेंगे।

